

Work & Life

How to build your shift pattern

A complete, step-by-step walkthrough — every screen, every button.

- Worked example: building a 4-on / 4-off rotation from scratch
- All four ways to reach the pattern builder
- Creating and managing your own shift types
- What every control on the builder does

Screens captured from Work & Life v3.7

The four ways to build a pattern

All of them end up in the same builder — pick whichever suits you

A 'pattern' is your repeating shift cycle. You describe it once, and the app works out every future day from it — your calendar, your alarms, your pay. You never fill in a calendar by hand.

1. Settings -> Work rhythm -> Manage all patterns -> + New pattern

The main route, and the one this guide follows in full. Use it any time after first setup. You can keep as many patterns as you like and switch between them.

2. Settings -> Work rhythm -> Ready-made patterns

Pick a common rotation from a catalogue of 21, then edit it. Fastest if your rotation is a standard one such as 3 Days / 3 Nights / 6 Off.

3. Settings -> Work rhythm -> tap your active pattern

Opens the same builder on the pattern you are already using, so you can change it.

4. During first-time setup

On a brand-new install the welcome flow offers 'Build your pattern' and 'Ready-made pattern' as cards. Same builder, same catalogue.

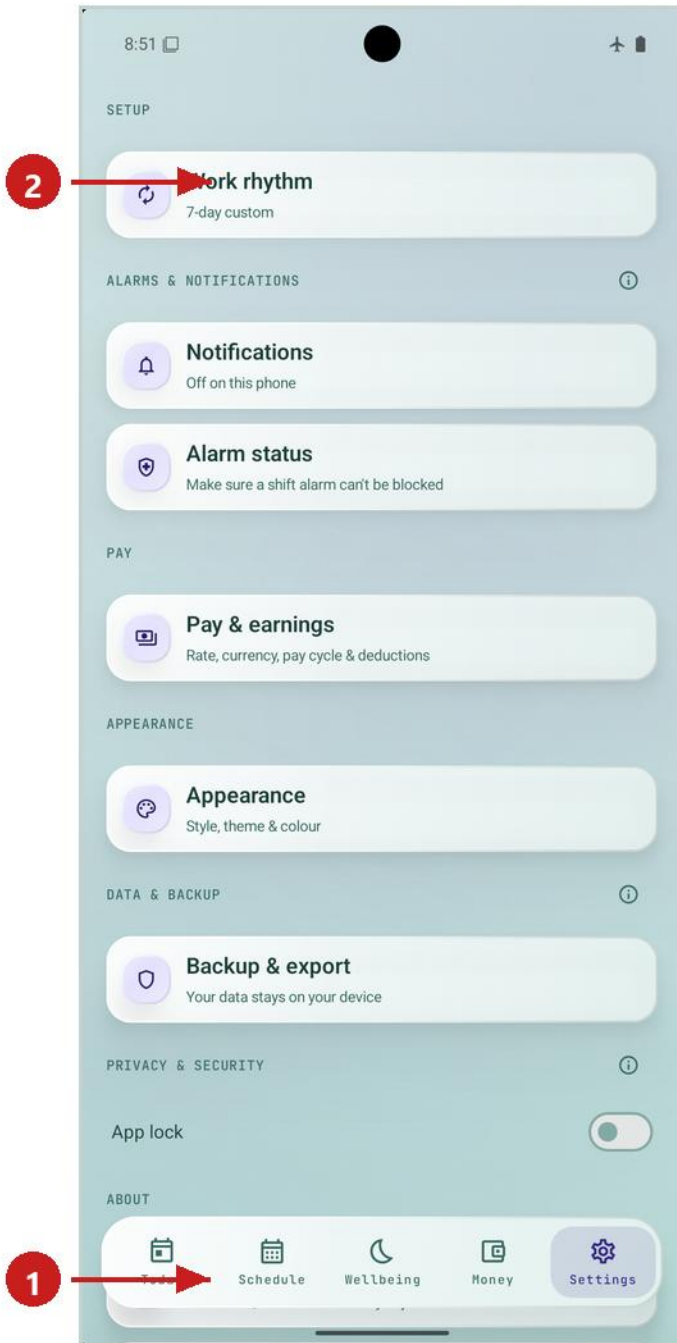
Whichever route you take, the builder is identical. Learn it once and every route is easy.

Step 1 · Open Settings

Tap the Settings tab, then Work rhythm

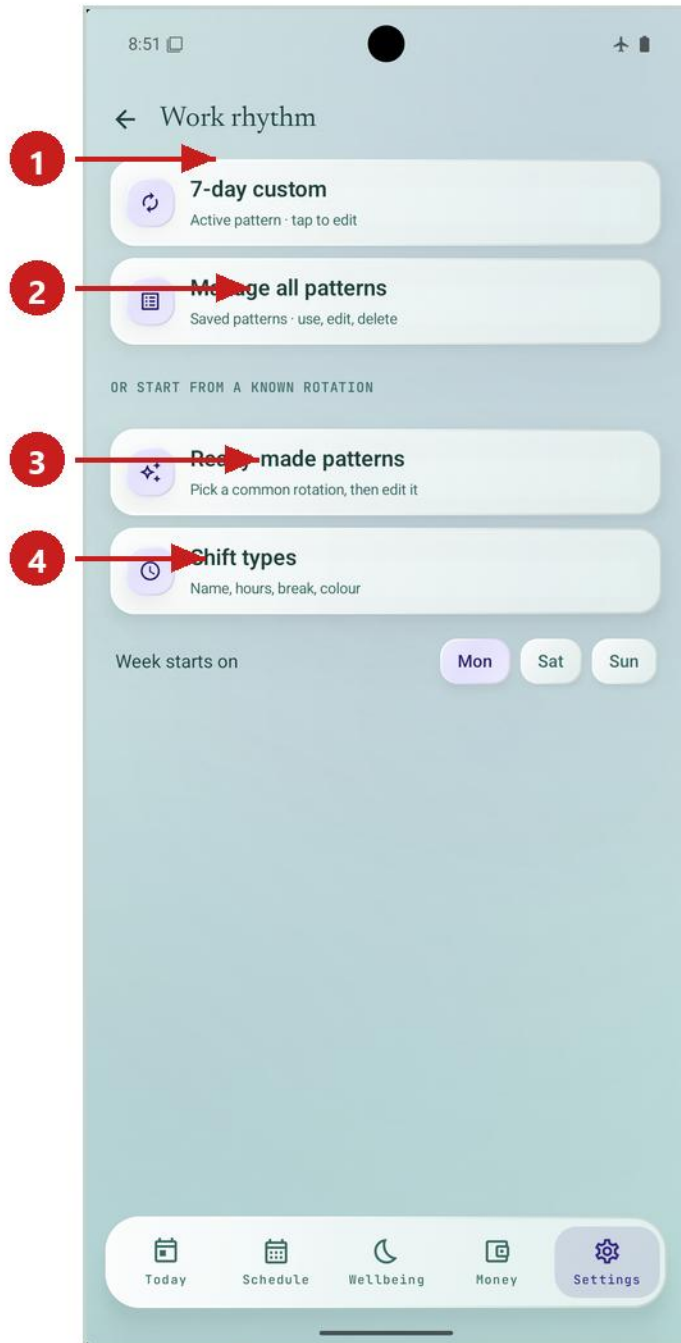
Everything about patterns lives in one place.

- 1 Tap Settings — the last tab on the bottom bar.
- 2 Under the SETUP heading, tap Work rhythm. The grey line beneath it shows the pattern you are using now (here, '7-day custom').



Step 2 · The Work rhythm page

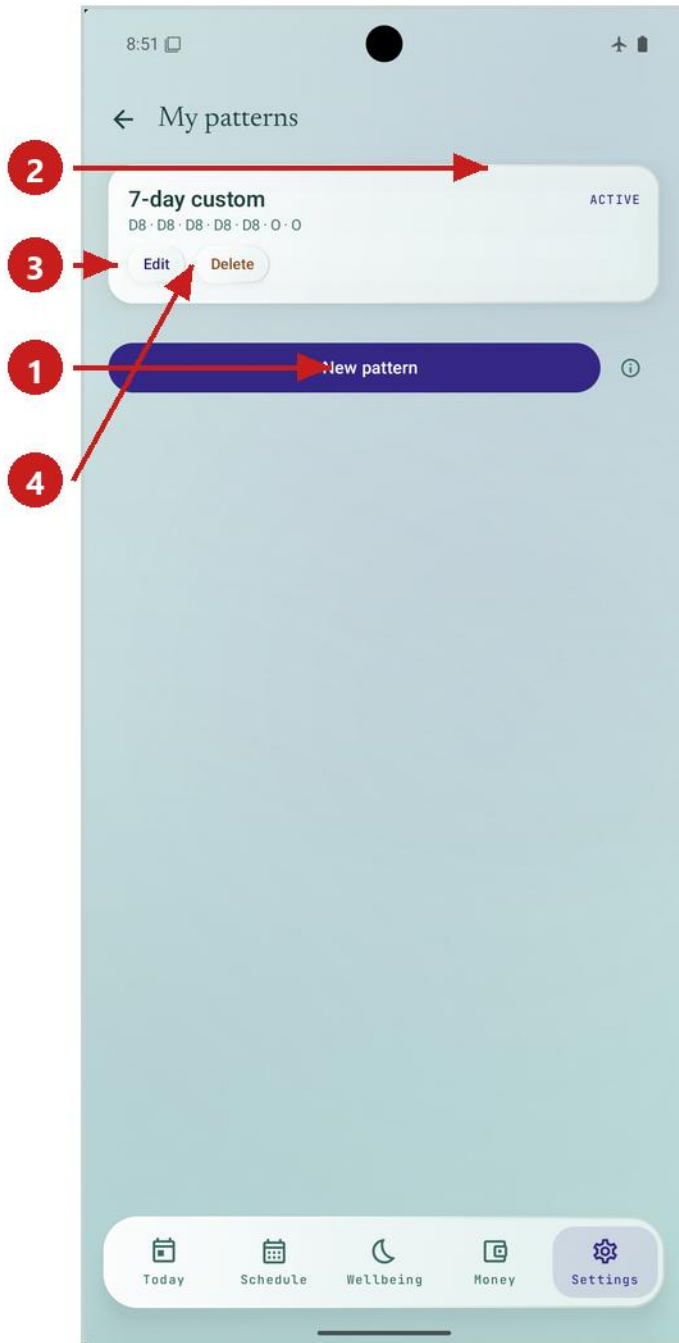
Four routes start here — this is the map



- 1 Your active pattern. Tap it to edit the pattern you are using right now.
- 2 Manage all patterns — the full list. Build new ones, switch, edit or delete. This guide follows this route.
- 3 Ready-made patterns — a catalogue of 21 common rotations you can start from.
- 4 Shift types — where the names, hours, break and colour of each shift are kept. Patterns are built out of these.

Step 3 · My patterns

Every pattern you have saved



If you have other patterns saved, each gets a 'Use' button here to switch to it.

- 1 + New pattern — starts a blank builder. Tap this.
- 2 ACTIVE marks the pattern currently driving your calendar. Only one can be active.
- 3 Edit — reopen this pattern in the builder.
- 4 Delete — remove it. If you delete the active one the app warns you first, because your calendar would empty and shift alarms would stop.

Step 4 · The builder, explained

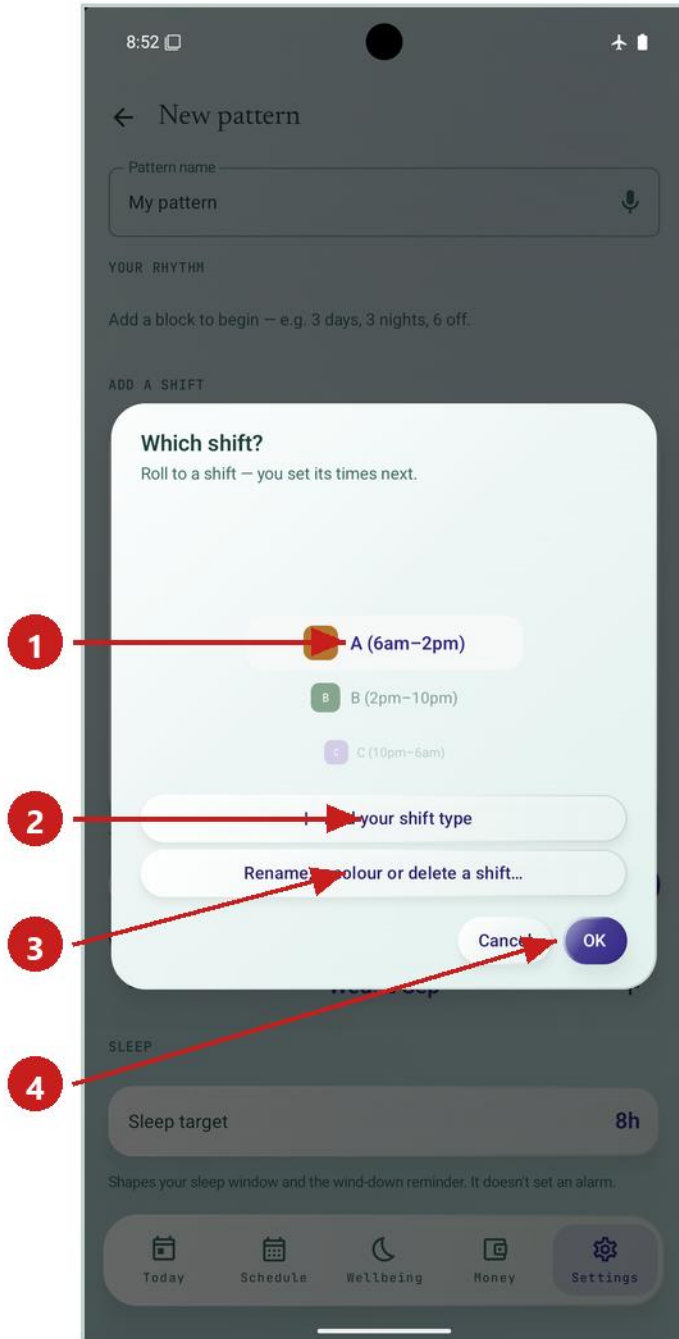
Every control on the New pattern screen

The screenshot shows the 'New pattern' screen in a mobile app. At the top, there's a back arrow and the title 'New pattern'. Below it is a 'Pattern name' field with a microphone icon. A red arrow labeled '1' points to this field. Below the name field is the 'YOUR RHYTHM' section with a sub-header 'Add a block to begin — e.g. 3 days, 3 nights, 6 off.' and a red arrow labeled '2' pointing to it. Underneath is the 'ADD A SHIFT' section. A red arrow labeled '3' points to the 'Shift' dropdown menu. Below that, a red arrow labeled '4' points to the 'Starts' field showing '6:00 AM'. Another red arrow labeled '4' points to the 'Ends' field showing '2:00 PM'. A red arrow labeled '5' points to the 'Break' field showing 'None'. Below that, a red arrow labeled '5' points to the 'How many days' field showing '3 days'. A red arrow labeled '6' points to a confirmation message 'These hours match your existing A (6am–2pm)'. Below that is a blue button labeled 'Add 3 × A' with a red arrow labeled '7' pointing to it. Below the button is the 'Which day is day 1?' section with a date selector showing 'Wed, 2 Sep' and a red arrow labeled '8' pointing to it. Below that is the 'SLEEP' section with a 'Sleep target' field showing '8h' and a red arrow labeled '9' pointing to it. At the bottom is a navigation bar with icons for 'Today', 'Schedule', 'Wellbeing', 'Money', and 'Settings'.

- 1 Pattern name. Give it something you'll recognise — 'Ward rota', '4 on 4 off'.
- 2 YOUR RHYTHM — your cycle so far. Empty to begin with.
- 3 Shift — which shift type this block uses. Tap to choose or create one.
- 4 Starts / Ends — the hours for this block.
- 5 Break — unpaid minutes taken off your hours. Affects pay, not alarms.
- 6 How many days — how many days in a row this shift runs.
- 7 Add — adds that block to the cycle. You press this once per block.
- 8 Which day is day 1 — the real date your cycle starts. Get this right or your whole calendar lands on the wrong day.
- 9 Sleep target — shapes your sleep window and wind-down reminder. Not an alarm.

Step 5 · Choosing a shift type

Tap the Shift row to open this

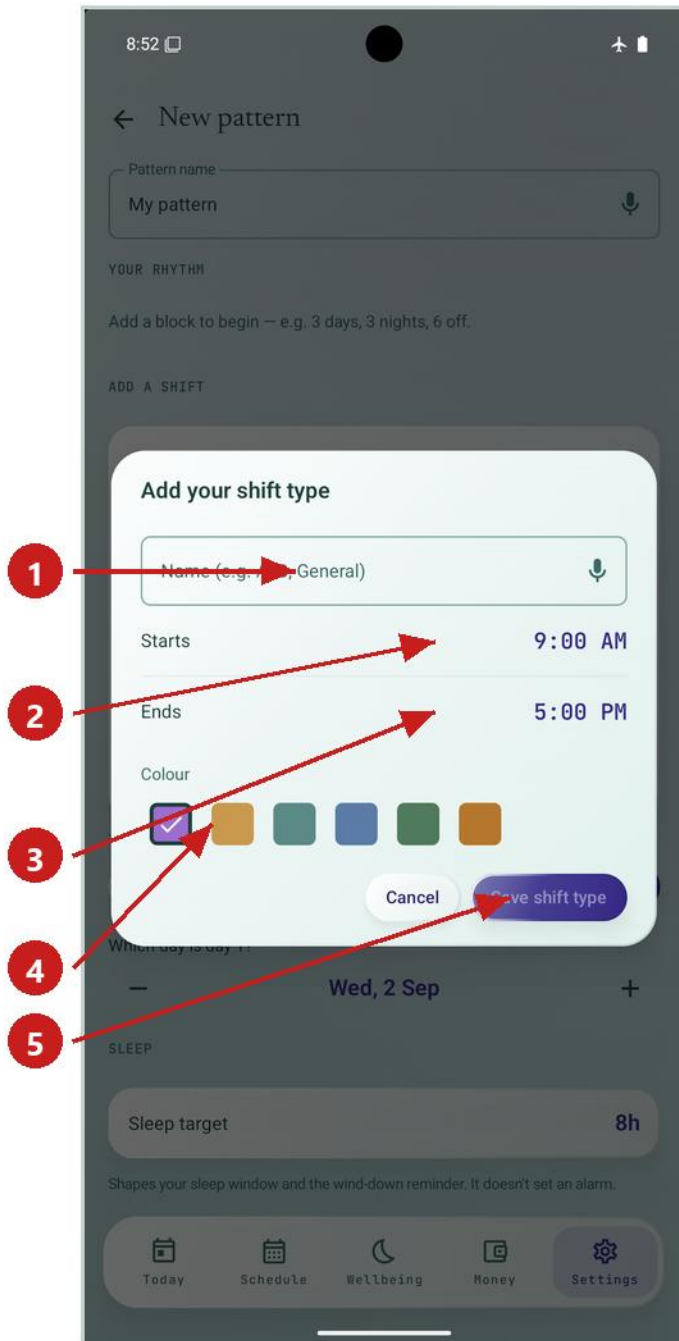


Every pattern is built from shift types. Think of them as your building blocks.

- 1 Roll the wheel to pick a shift. A, B and C are ready-made starters — A is 6am-2pm, B is 2pm-10pm, C is 10pm-6am.
- 2 + Add your shift type — create your own, with your own name, hours and colour. We'll do this next.
- 3 Rename, recolour or delete a shift — manage the ones you already have.
- 4 OK confirms your choice.

Step 6 · Creating your own shift type

Our example needs a 12-hour Day shift



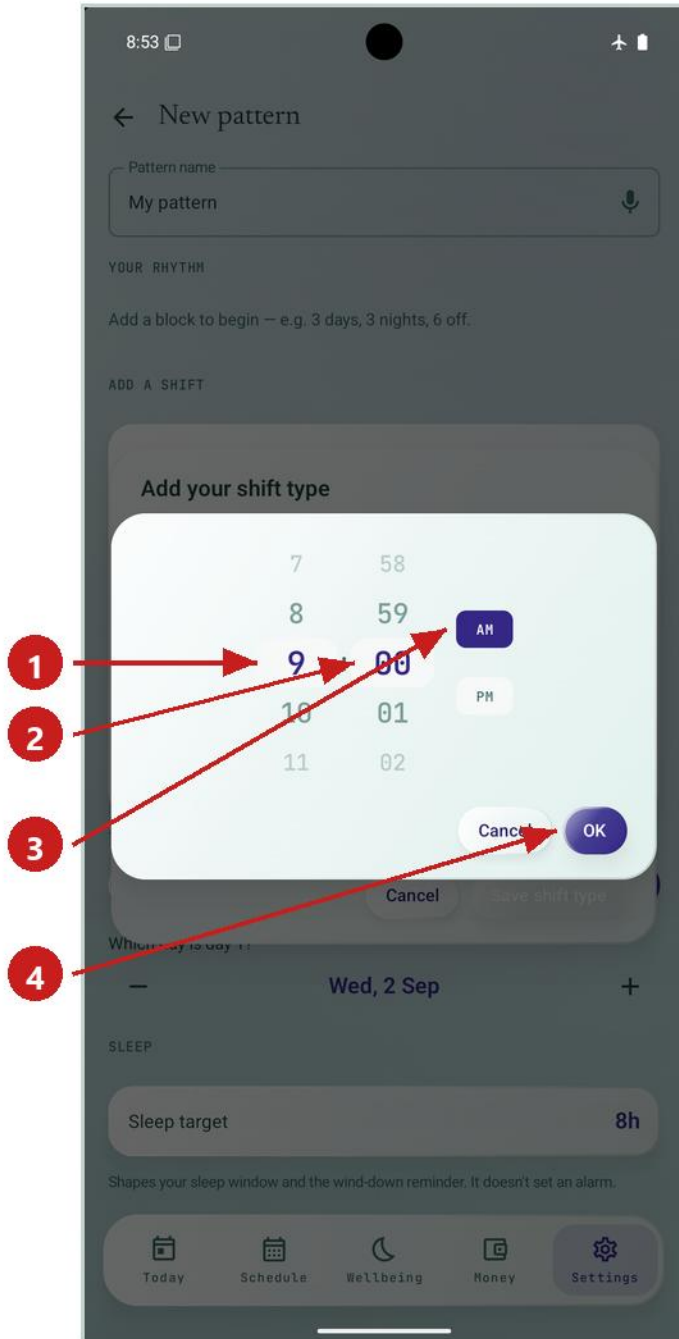
- 1 Name it. Short names work best on the calendar — 'Day', 'Night', 'Early'.
- 2 Starts — tap to open the time wheel.
- 3 Ends — the same. A shift that ends earlier than it starts is treated as overnight, so 6pm to 6am is understood correctly.
- 4 Colour — how this shift looks on your calendar. Pick contrasting colours so you can read the month at a glance.
- 5 Save shift type. It stays available for every pattern from now on.

Step 7 · Setting a time

The same wheel is used everywhere in the app

No keyboard needed anywhere in this app — everything is a roll or a tap.

- 1 Hours — swipe up or down. Swipe down for earlier, up for later.
- 2 Minutes — same again.
- 3 AM / PM — tap to switch.
- 4 OK to confirm. We set 6:00 AM for the start and 6:00 PM for the end.

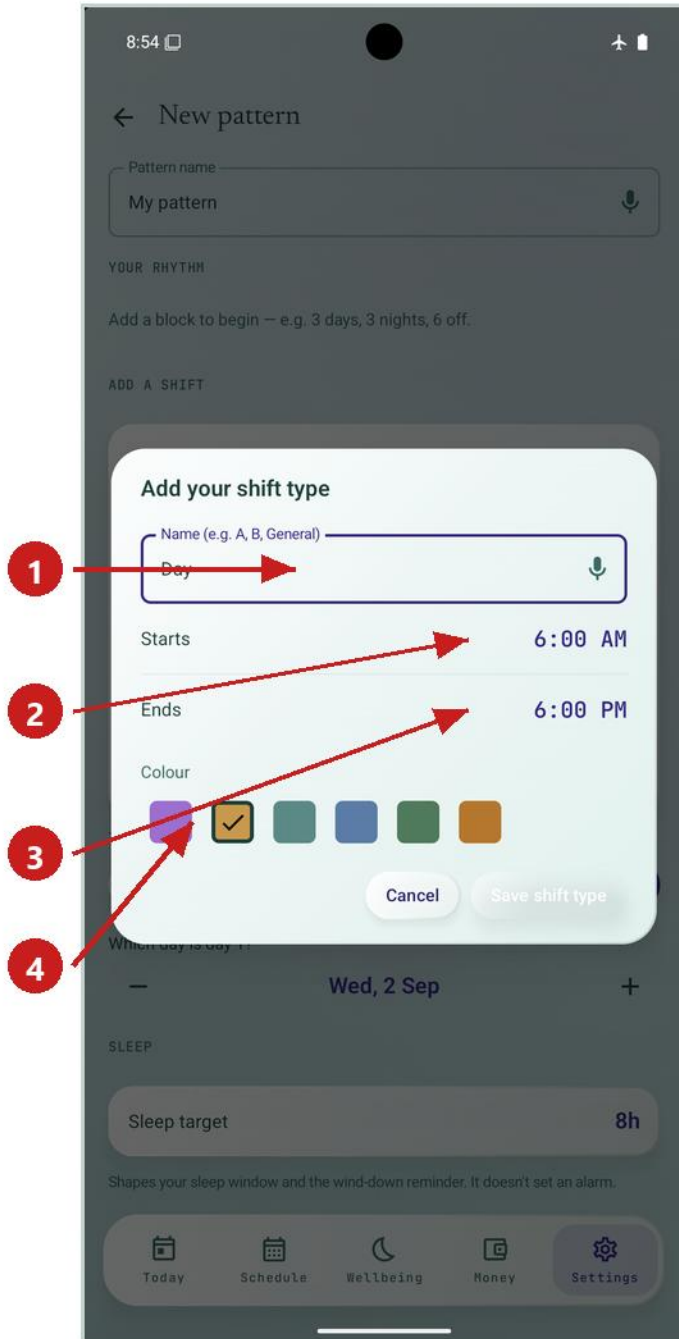


Step 8 · The finished shift type

'Day', 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM, amber

Tap Save shift type. You return to the builder with this shift already selected.

- 1 The name you typed.
- 2 6:00 AM start.
- 3 6:00 PM end — a 12-hour day shift.
- 4 The chosen colour is ticked.



Step 9 · How many days in a row

Set the length of this block

A 'block' is a run of the same shift. Build the cycle one block at a time.

- 1 Shift now shows 'Day' with the hours you set.
- 2 How many days — tap and roll to 2. Our rotation is two days, then two nights.
- 3 The button updates to '+ Add 2 x Day'. Tap it.

8:56

← New pattern

Pattern name
My pattern

YOUR RHYTHM

Add a block to begin — e.g. 3 days, 3 nights, 6 off.

ADD A SHIFT

Shift	Day
Starts	6:00 AM
Ends	6:00 PM
Break Unpaid — taken off your hours	None
How many days	2 days

These hours match your existing Day

1 2 3 Add 2 x Day

Which day is day 1?

— Wed, 2 Sep +

SLEEP

Sleep target 8h

Shapes your sleep window and the wind-down reminder. It doesn't set an alarm.

Today Schedule Wellbeing Money Settings

Step 10 · The first block lands

Two Day shifts are now in the cycle

8:57

← New pattern

Pattern name
My pattern

YOUR RHYTHM

1 2 Day · 2-day cycle

2 Day

ADD A SHIFT

3

Shift	Day
Starts	6:00 AM
Ends	6:00 PM
Break Unpaid — taken off your hours	None
How many days	2 days

These hours match your existing Day

+ Add 2 x Day

Which day is day 1?

— Wed, 2 Sep +

2-MONTH PROJECTION ⓘ

From day 1 · Wed, 2 Sep

Today Schedule Wellbeing Money Settings

Now repeat for the nights: choose the shift, set the days, press Add.

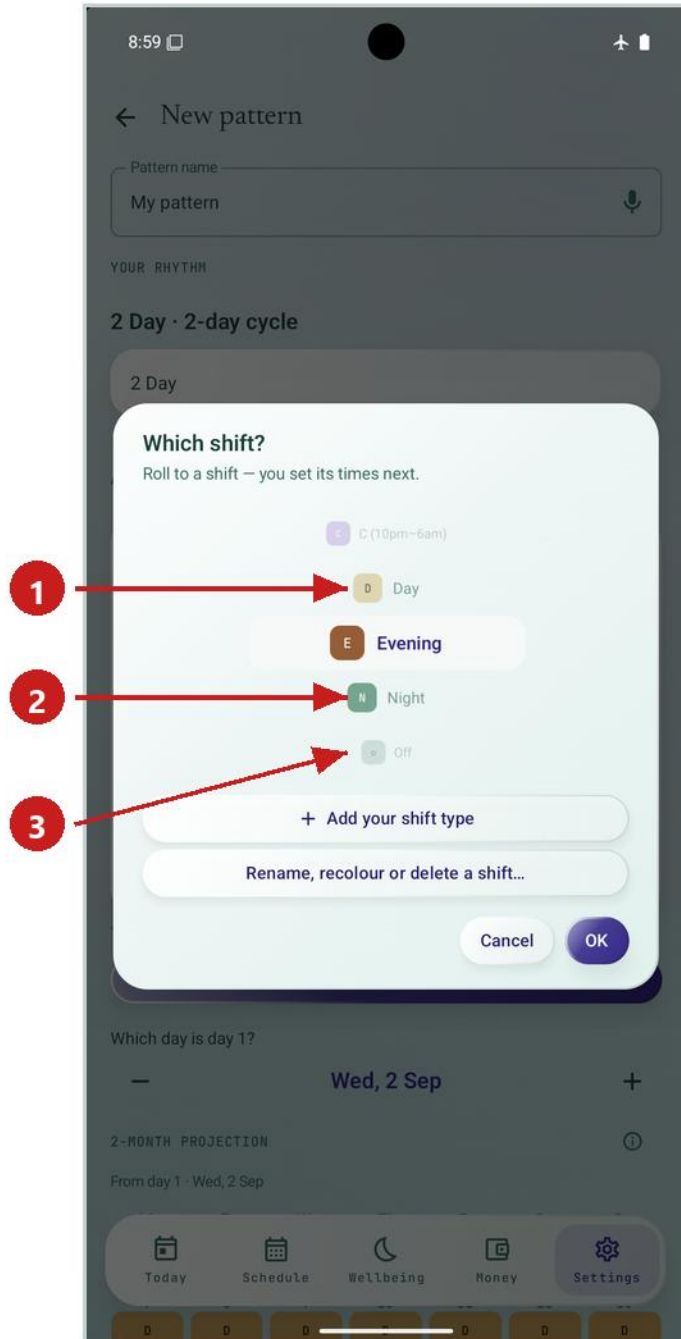
- 1 YOUR RHYTHM now reads '2 Day - 2-day cycle'. The summary updates as you go.
- 2 The block appears as a row. A cross on the right removes it if you get it wrong.
- 3 The ADD A SHIFT card stays below, ready for the next block.

Step 11 · Your shift types collect up

Everything you create stays available

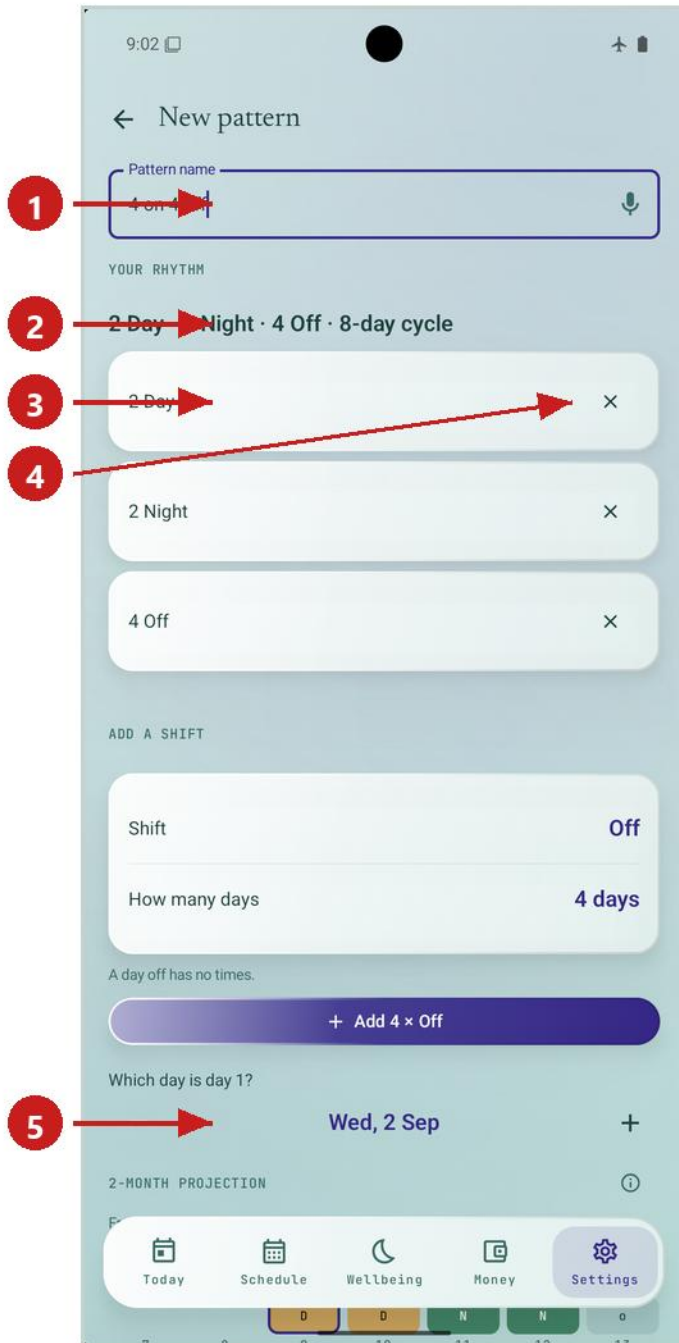
Roll the wheel to see them all: A, B, C, Day, Evening, Night, Off, Comp off, Home.

- 1 'Day' — the one we just made.
- 2 'Night' — created the same way, 6:00 PM to 6:00 AM, green.
- 3 'Off' — a rest day. It has no times, and no alarms are set for it.



Step 12 · The complete pattern

2 Day, 2 Night, 4 Off — an 8-day cycle

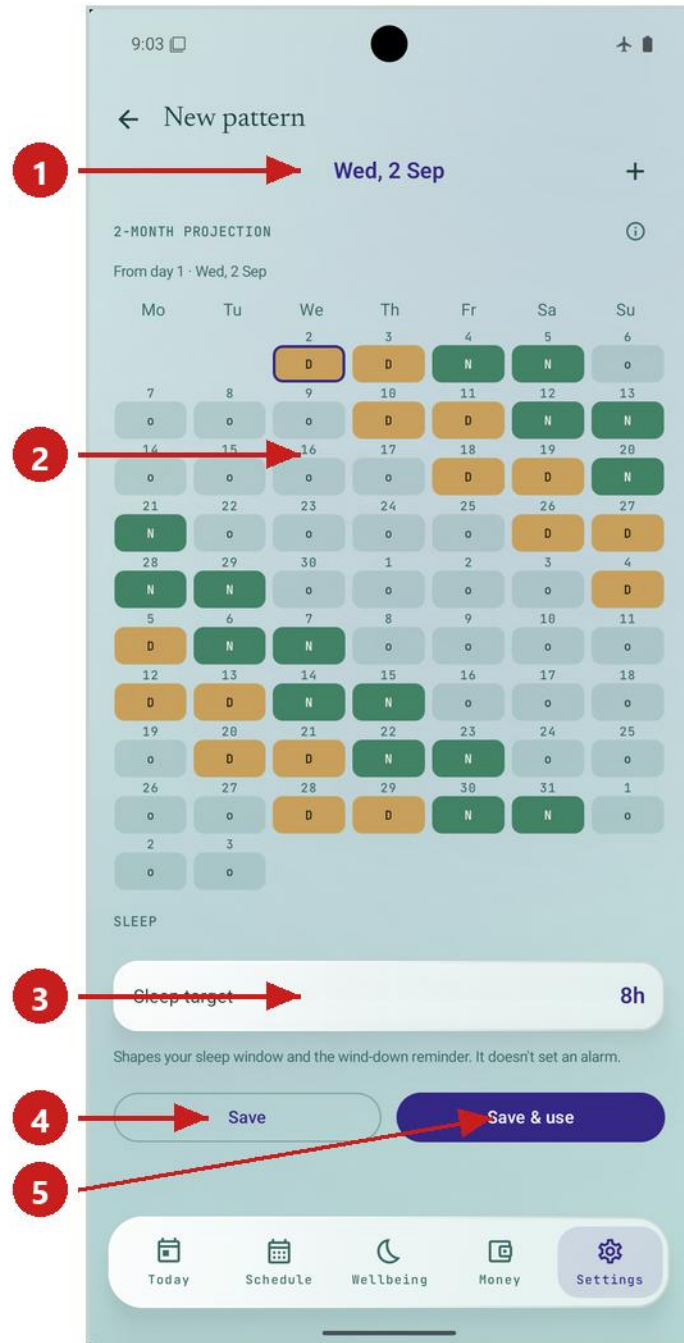


Off days are added exactly like worked ones — choose 'Off', set 4 days, press Add.

- 1 Name your pattern — we used '4 on 4 off'.
- 2 The summary line confirms the whole cycle and its length.
- 3 One row per block, in order: 2 Day, then 2 Night, then 4 Off.
- 4 The cross deletes a block. Blocks always run in the order shown.
- 5 'Which day is day 1?' sits below — set it to the real date your cycle begins. Use the minus and plus, or tap the date for a calendar.

Step 13 · Check it, then save

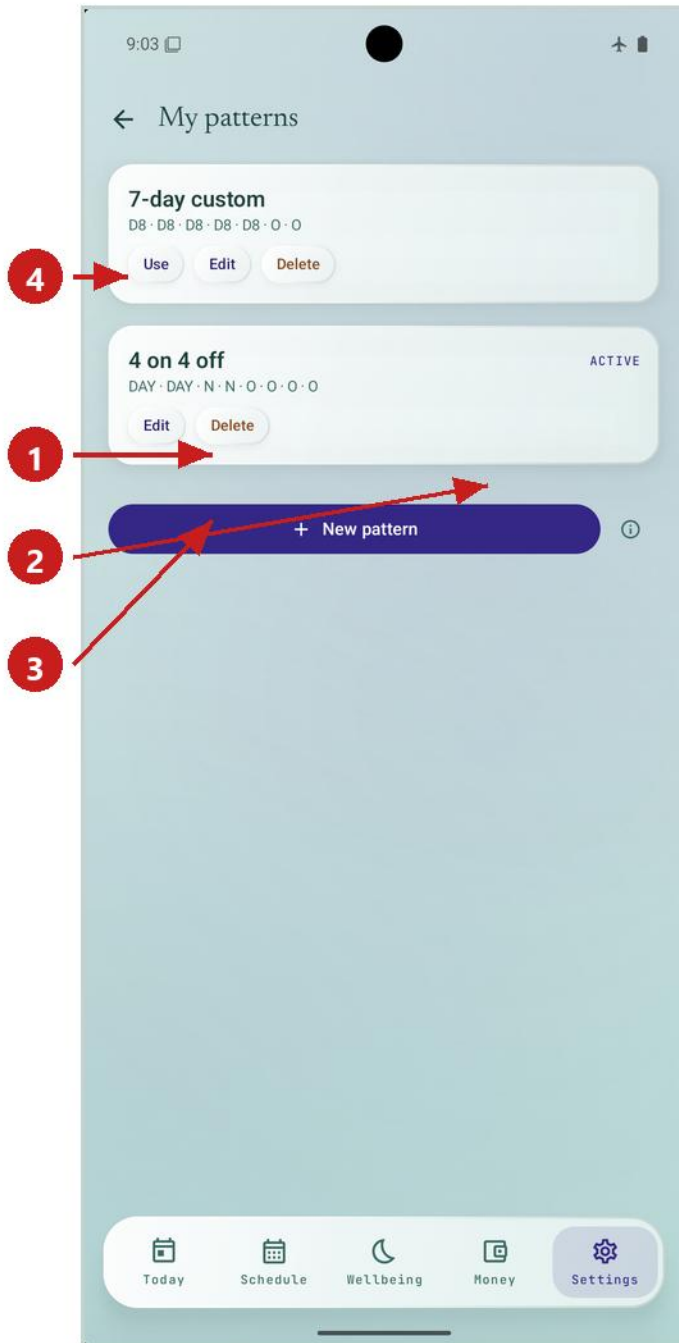
The projection proves the pattern before you commit



- 1 Which day is day 1 — every date below is worked out from this.
- 2 2-MONTH PROJECTION — the next two months, laid out from day 1. Day 1 is ringed. Check a date you already know before saving.
- 3 Sleep target — 8h by default.
- 4 Save — keeps the pattern but does NOT switch to it.
- 5 Save & use — keeps it AND makes it your active pattern. This is usually what you want.

Step 14 · Saved

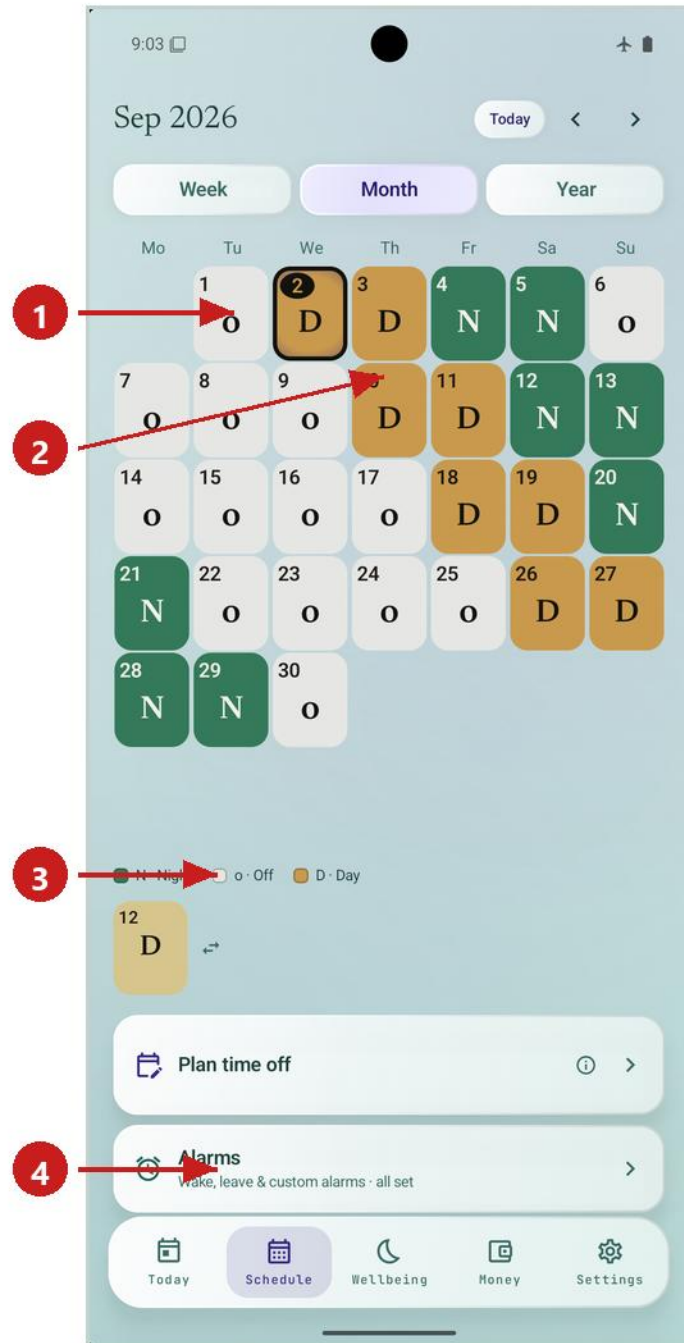
Your new pattern is now active



- 1 '4 on 4 off' — the pattern we just built.
- 2 ACTIVE — it is now driving your calendar and alarms.
- 3 The sequence in full: DAY, DAY, N, N, O, O, O, O.
- 4 The old pattern is still saved. Its 'Use' button switches back any time — nothing is lost by experimenting.

Step 15 · The result

Your calendar, filled in automatically



This is the point of the whole exercise: describe the cycle once, get every future day.

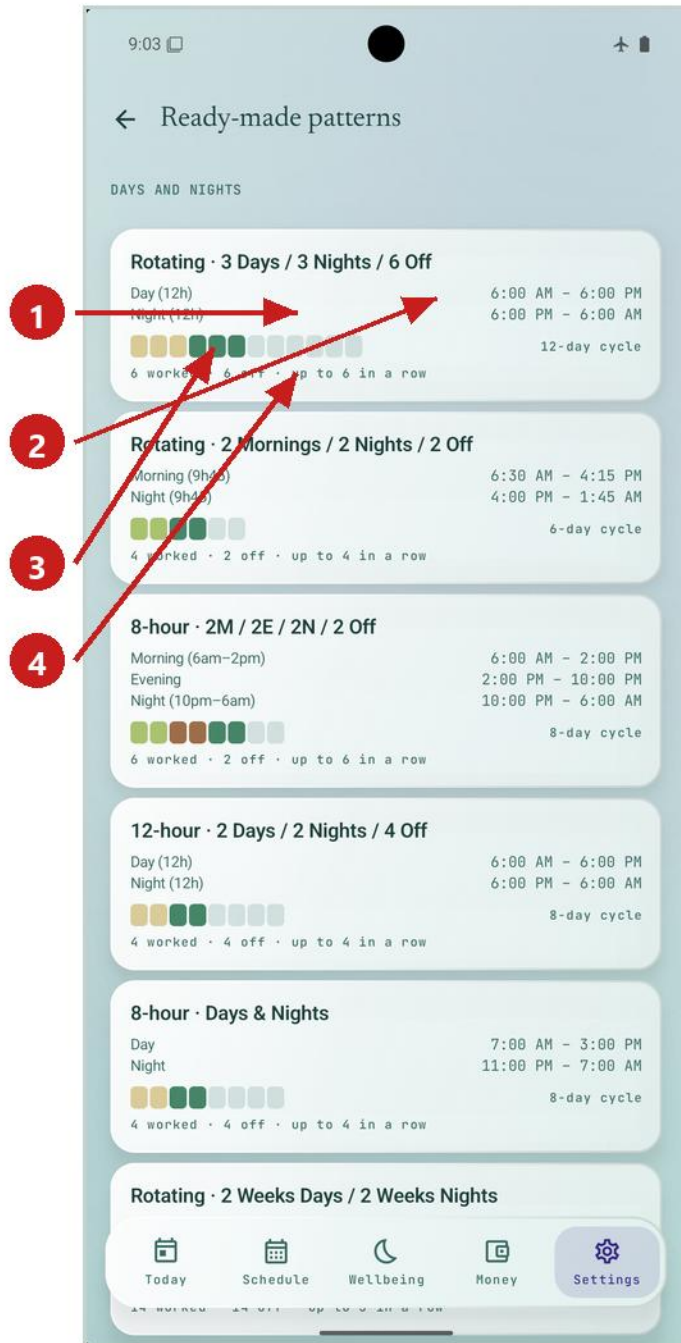
- 1 Today is ringed. From here the pattern repeats forever — you never fill this in by hand.
- 2 Two amber Days, two green Nights, four grey Offs, over and over.
- 3 The legend names each colour.
- 4 Alarms are already set from your pattern — 'Wake, leave & custom alarms - all set'.

Another way · Ready-made patterns

Settings -> Work rhythm -> Ready-made patterns

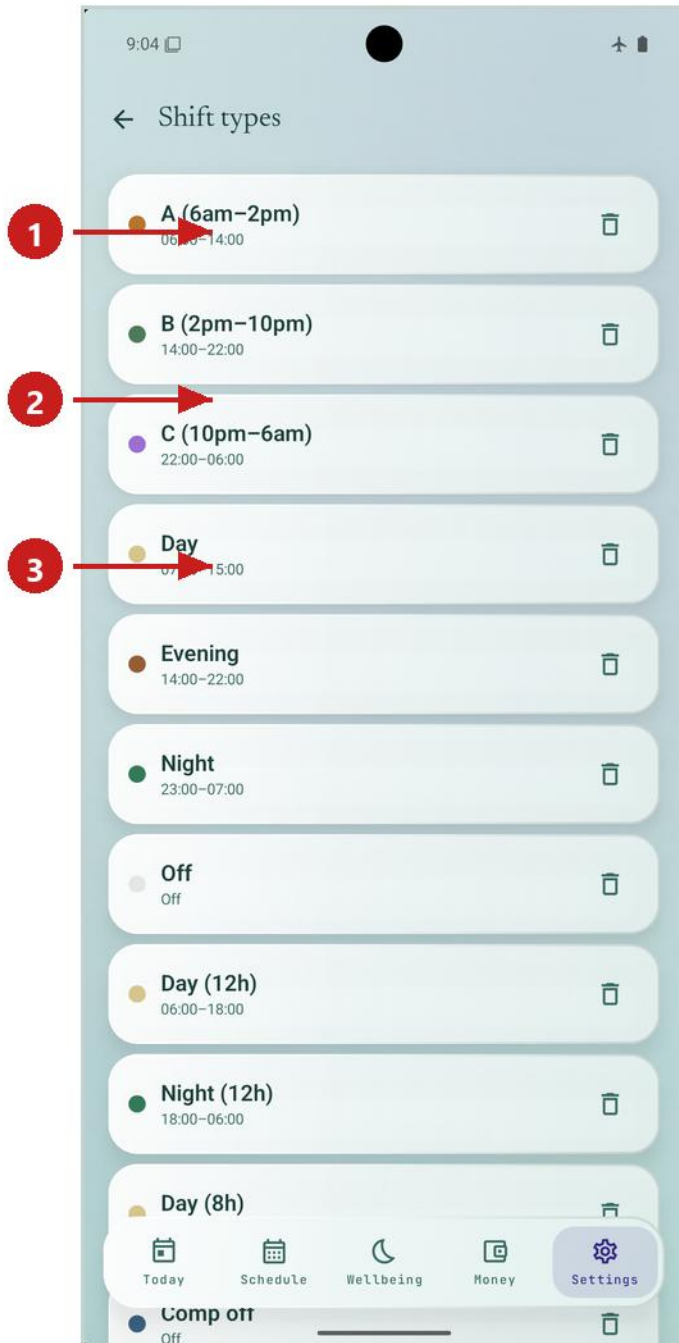
21 common rotations. Tap one and it opens in the same builder, already filled in — then change anything you like before saving.

- 1 The rotation's name and shape.
- 2 The exact hours of each shift it uses.
- 3 A colour strip showing the whole cycle at a glance.
- 4 The cycle length, plus how many days are worked, how many off, and the longest run in a row.



Managing shift types

Settings -> Work rhythm -> Shift types



Everything you build patterns from lives here. Tap any type to rename it, change its hours, break or colour. Changing a type updates every pattern that uses it.

- 1 The starter types A, B and C, with their hours.
- 2 The types you create appear here too.
- 3 'Off' has no hours — it is a rest day.

Things worth knowing

The details that save you trouble later

Day 1 is the setting that matters most

Everything is counted forward from day 1. If your calendar looks right in shape but wrong by a day or two, day 1 is almost always the cause. Change it in the builder — the projection updates instantly so you can check before saving.

Save vs Save & use

'Save' stores the pattern and leaves your current one running. 'Save & use' stores it AND switches to it. Only one pattern is active at a time; the rest sit in My patterns waiting.

Blocks run in the order you add them

Add 2 Day, then 2 Night, then 4 Off and the cycle is exactly that. To reorder, remove a block with the cross and add it again in the right place.

Changing a pattern changes past weeks too

Pay and hours are worked out from your pattern every time you look, not stored week by week. So editing a pattern changes what past weeks show. Days you changed by hand on the calendar are kept exactly as they are. The app warns you before this happens.

Overnight shifts are handled for you

An end time earlier than the start time means the shift runs past midnight. 6:00 PM to 6:00 AM is understood as a 12-hour night, not a minus-12-hour mistake.

Quick reference

The whole flow on one page

Build a pattern from scratch

Settings -> Work rhythm -> Manage all patterns -> + New pattern

- Name it.
- Tap Shift, pick or create a shift type, set Starts and Ends.
- Set How many days, then press + Add.
- Repeat for every block, including the Off days.
- Set 'Which day is day 1?' to the real start date.
- Check the 2-month projection against a date you know.
- Save & use.

Start from a ready-made rotation

Settings -> Work rhythm -> Ready-made patterns -> pick one -> edit if needed -> Save & use

Edit the pattern you are using

Settings -> Work rhythm -> tap the active pattern at the top

Create or change a shift type

Settings -> Work rhythm -> Shift types, or '+ Add your shift type' inside the Shift picker

Rule of thumb: shift types are the ingredients, blocks are the recipe, and day 1 tells the app when to start cooking.